TRT 18

# Tongkat ali (Eurycoma longifolia)

Root of Eurycoma longifolia, a Southeast Asian plant also called Malaysian ginseng



| CLASS | STUDIED FOR | HUMAN EVIDENCE | US STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Plant extract | Testosterone, stress, erections | Controlled human trials (small, short) | Dietary supplement · not an approved drug |

## STUDIED FOR

| Testosterone | Stress and mood | Erectile function |
|---|---|---|
| HUMAN + ANIMAL | HUMAN | HUMAN |

| Sperm | Bone |
|---|---|
| ANIMAL | ANIMAL |

**Trials are small and short.** Most used standardized water extracts in Malaysia. One case report describes liver injury after use.

## HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Root extract ▶ Root compounds ▶ Sex hormones ▶ Testosterone

- **In rats,** root compounds showed aphrodisiac and testosterone effects
- **In young men,** testosterone and estradiol rose; LH, FSH, SHBG did not change
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

## EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

### EVIDENCE

**CONTROLLED TRIALS**
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Placebo-controlled trials, 32 to 63 people
- 2 weeks to 6 months each
- 1 case report of liver injury

### NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Drug interactions
- Contents of products sold

## QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

| HALF-LIFE | ROUTES STUDIED |
|---|---|
| Not established in people | By mouth (standardized water extract) in trials |
| **PHARMACOKINETICS** | **SOLD AS** |
| Not established | Dietary supplement; not FDA reviewed before sale |
| **MONITORED IN TRIALS** | **SPORT (WADA)** |
| Testosterone, cortisol, symptom and erectile function scores | Not on the 2026 list |

| REGULATORY | FDA | No approved drug; sold as dietary supplement | WADA | Not listed |
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REFERENCES

1. Medicina (Kaunas), Eurycoma longifolia and testosterone meta-analysis, Aug 2022
2. Andrologia, tongkat ali in healthy young men, May 2021
3. Cureus, tongkat ali liver injury case report, Mar 2024



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